

# Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

## Chapter 1: वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram)

### Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

|                        |                                             |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Subject</b>         | Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)          |
| <b>Chapter</b>         | 1 — वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram) |
| <b>Total Questions</b> | 60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)        |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b>   | 240                                         |
| <b>Suggested Time</b>  | 90 minutes                                  |

**Marking scheme:** +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

**Instructions:** Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: वन्दे/नमः govern the ACCUSATIVE while नमः-with-dative is a different construction; मातृ is an ऋकारान्त (r-stem) feminine whose accusative singular is मातरम् (not मात्राम् or मातृम्); रत्नाकरः and पर्वतराजः are तत्पुरुष/बहुव्रीहि compounds read by their members; instrumental -भिः marks the MEANS not the agent's possession; and ह्रस्व/दीर्घ vowel length is meaning-bearing (आनन्द ≠ अनन्द). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

- A student paraphrases वन्दे मातरम् as 'Salutations are offered by me to the Mother.' Is this an acceptable rendering of the sense?
  - No — वन्दे is passive, so 'salutations are offered' wrongly makes the Mother the agent.
  - No — वन्दे means 'I love', so it must mention love, not salutation.
  - Yes — वन्दे is first-person singular 'I salute/revere', so '(I) offer salutation to the Mother' captures the active reverence.
  - No — मातरम् is nominative, so the Mother must be the one saluting.
- Which English verb pair best separates the meaning of वन्दे from a verb of affection?
  - वन्दे = 'I salute/revere'; a verb of affection would be 'I love/feel tenderness'.
  - वन्दे = 'I love'; a verb of reverence would be 'I salute'.
  - वन्दे = 'I see'; a verb of affection would be 'I salute'.
  - वन्दे = 'I give'; a verb of affection would be 'I bow'.
- In the line वन्दे मातरम्, सुजलाम् सुफलाम् (saluting the Mother, well-watered and well-fruited), the words सुजलाम् and सुफलाम् are in the same case as मातरम् because they:

- (A) are the subjects of the sentence, so they stand in the nominative
- (B) express the means by which the Mother is watered, so they are instrumental
- (C) show possession of the Mother, so they are genitive
- (D) are adjectives qualifying मातरम्, so they agree with it in the accusative singular feminine

4. Why is वन्दे said to govern the accusative, while a sentence like 'नमो मात्रे' (homage to the mother) can take a dative?

- (A) Both वन्दे and नमस् always require the accusative and never anything else.
- (B) वन्दे takes the dative and नमस् takes the accusative — the rule is reversed.
- (C) वन्दे is a transitive verb taking a direct object in the accusative; the indeclinable नमस् can instead be construed with a dative meaning 'homage TO'.
- (D) Neither word takes any case; both are used with bare stems.

5. The feminine stem मातृ ('mother') is an ऋकारान्त (ऋ-ending) noun. Its accusative singular is मातरम्. By the same pattern, the related kinship stem स्वसृ ('sister') would form its accusative singular as:

- |              |               |
|--------------|---------------|
| (A) स्वसृम्  | (B) स्वस्राम् |
| (C) स्वसारम् | (D) स्वसाः    |

6. A learner writes वन्दे मात्राम्, thinking मात्रा is the accusative of 'mother'. What is the actual error?

- (A) मात्राम् is the correct accusative of मातृ, so there is no error.
- (B) The error is only that वन्दे should take the nominative मात्रा.
- (C) मात्राम् is fine but वन्दे should be वन्दामि.
- (D) मात्रा is a different word ('measure/quantity'); the accusative of मातृ is मातरम्, so मात्राम् both mis-declines and changes the word.

7. Consider the phrase वन्दे हिमालयम् ('I salute the Himalaya'). Why does हिमालयः become हिमालयम् here?

- (A) हिमालयः is feminine, so -म् marks the feminine accusative.
- (B) It is the object of वन्दे, so the अकारान्त masculine हिमालयः takes its accusative-singular ending -म्.
- (C) हिमालयम् is the genitive showing 'of the Himalaya'.
- (D) वन्दे takes the nominative, and हिमालयम् simply is the nominative.

8. If one wished to salute TWO mothers, 'वन्दे मातरौ' would be needed. The ending -औ on मातरौ marks:

- (A) the accusative singular (one mother)
- (B) the accusative DUAL (two mothers as object)
- (C) the nominative plural (many mothers as subject)
- (D) the genitive singular (of the mother)

9. In वन्दे सस्यश्यामलाम् मातरम्, the adjective ends in -आम् (सस्यश्यामलाम्) rather than -अम्. The long आ before -म् appears because:

- (A) all accusative singulars end in -आम् regardless of gender.
- (B) the adjective is feminine (आकारान्त श्यामला), whose accusative singular ends in -आम्, agreeing with the feminine मातरम्.
- (C) -आम् marks the plural here, so it means 'many green mothers'.
- (D) the long आ is a sandhi error and should be a short अ.

10. Which sentence correctly says 'I salute the well-fruited Mother', keeping case-agreement?

- (A) वन्दे सुफला माता
- (B) वन्दे सुफलायाः मातुः
- (C) वन्दे सुफलाम् मातरम्
- (D) वन्दे सुफलम् मातरम्

11. रत्नाकरः ('ocean') is analysed as रत्नानाम् आकरः ('a mine of jewels'). By the same compound logic, जलाकरः would most naturally mean:

- (A) a king of water
- (B) without water (water-less)
- (C) a reservoir / 'mine' of water
- (D) one who carries jewels

12. पर्वतराजः is read as पर्वतानाम् राजा ('king OF mountains'), a tatpuruṣa where the first member stands in a hidden genitive. Which expansion shows the SAME structure?

- (A) महाराजः = महान् राजा ('great king'), an adjective + noun
- (B) देवराजः = देवानाम् राजा ('king of the gods')
- (C) राजपुत्रः read as 'king is a son'
- (D) राजा च पर्वतः च ('a king and a mountain')

13. सस्यश्यामला splits as सस्य + श्यामला = 'dark-green WITH crops'. The relation between the members is best described as:

- (A) instrumental-type — 'made dark/green BY crops' (तृतीया-तत्पुरुष)
- (B) coordinative — 'crops and darkness' (द्वन्द्व)
- (C) possessive of an outside thing — 'one whose crops are dark' (बहुव्रीहि)
- (D) a mere repetition of the same word

14. देशभक्तः and धर्मभक्तः share the head भक्तः ('devoted one'). A compound formed as विद्याभक्तः would therefore mean one devoted to:

- (A) the country (देश)
- (B) duty (धर्म)
- (C) knowledge / learning (विद्या)
- (D) the ocean (समुद्र)

15. कृषकबान्धवाः ('farmer-brethren') treats बान्धव as the head. The plural ending -आः on बान्धवाः signals that the word is:

- (A) accusative singular (one farmer as object)
- (B) nominative plural masculine (the farmers, as a group of subjects)
- (C) instrumental plural (by means of the farmers)
- (D) genitive singular (of the farmer)

16. Which compound is correctly matched to its split and meaning?

- (A) पर्वतराजः → पर्व + तराज → 'a festival of kings'  
 (B) सस्यश्यामला → सस्य + अश्यामला → 'crops without darkness'  
 (C) रत्नाकरः → रत्न + आकर → 'mine of jewels' (the ocean)  
 (D) देशभक्तः → देशभ + क्तः → 'a shining country'

**17.** In समुद्रः भारतमातुः चरणौ प्रक्षालयति, the form भारतमातुः is genitive. The matching genitive of the plain stem मातृ alone is:

- (A) मातुः (B) मातरम्  
 (C) मातरि (D) मात्रा

**18.** If the poem instead spoke of 'the Motherland's HANDS' (हस्तौ) being honoured, the phrase would read भारतमातुः हस्तौ. Here भारतमातुः stays genitive because:

- (A) the noun हस्तौ is dual, which forces the previous word into the instrumental.  
 (B) it still expresses possession ('whose hands'), regardless of which body-part noun follows.  
 (C) body-parts always demand the locative on the possessor.  
 (D) changing चरणौ to हस्तौ turns भारतमातुः into the accusative.

**19.** The question कस्याः चरणौ समुद्रः प्रक्षालयति? uses कस्याः. This interrogative is the feminine genitive of किम्, so the expected answer भारतमातुः must also be:

- (A) feminine genitive singular, matching 'whose (feminine) feet'  
 (B) masculine nominative, naming the subject  
 (C) neuter accusative, naming the object  
 (D) feminine instrumental, naming the means

**20.** चरणौ ('the two feet') in समुद्रः चरणौ प्रक्षालयति is the object of प्रक्षालयति. Its ending -औ here marks the:

- (A) nominative singular (B) accusative dual (the two feet, as object)  
 (C) genitive dual ('of the two feet') (D) instrumental dual ('with the two feet')

**21.** Which sentence correctly states 'the ocean washes the Himalaya's feet' (an invented test phrase using the same pattern)?

- (A) समुद्रः हिमालयम् चरणौ प्रक्षालयति (B) समुद्रः हिमालयः चरणौ प्रक्षालयति  
 (C) समुद्रः हिमालयेन चरणौ प्रक्षालयति (D) समुद्रः हिमालयस्य चरणौ प्रक्षालयति

**22.** स्वेदबिन्दुभिः सिञ्चन्ति means 'they water with sweat-drops'. The ending -भिः is the instrumental plural. The instrumental plural of the neuter जल ('water') would be:

- (A) जलैः (B) जलानि  
 (C) जलेभ्यः (D) जलानाम्

**23.** A learner reads स्वेदबिन्दुभिः as 'OF the sweat-drops'. Why is that wrong?

- (A) -भिः is the instrumental ('with/by'), whereas 'of' would require the genitive (e.g. स्वेदबिन्दूनाम्).  
 (B) -भिः is the genitive, so 'of the drops' is actually correct.

(C) -भिः is the vocative, so it means 'O drops!'.

(D) -भिः is the accusative, so it means 'the drops' as object.

**24.** If the poem said the farmers water the land 'with their tears' (अश्रुभिः), the role of अश्रुभिः would be:

(A) nominative subject — 'the tears water'

(B) instrumental of means — 'by means of tears'

(C) dative recipient — 'to the tears'

(D) locative place — 'in the tears'

**25.** Distinguish the cases: in 'farmers (कृषकाः) water the land with sweat (स्वेदबिन्दुभिः)', कृषकाः and स्वेदबिन्दुभिः carry which roles?

(A) कृषकाः = instrumental means; स्वेदबिन्दुभिः = nominative agent

(B) both are instrumental, expressing two means

(C) कृषकाः = accusative object; स्वेदबिन्दुभिः = genitive possessor

(D) कृषकाः = nominative agent (the doers); स्वेदबिन्दुभिः = instrumental means (the 'with')

**26.** Why does स्वेदबिन्दुभिः use the plural form rather than a singular?

(A) Because the watering is done by MANY drops of sweat, so the plural is natural for the means.

(B) Because the instrumental case exists only in the plural.

(C) Because -भिः can never be singular and only marks plurals of any meaning.

(D) Because the farmers are plural, the means must automatically be plural too.

**27.** The word आनन्दः ('bliss') begins with a long आ. Lengthening or shortening this vowel matters because Sanskrit treats आ and अ as:

(A) the same sound written two ways, with no meaning difference

(B) a consonant and a vowel respectively (C) nasal and oral versions of one vowel

(D) two distinct sounds of different मात्रा (दीर्घ vs ह्रस्व) that can change a word's identity

**28.** A 'mātrā' (मात्रा) in this context is best understood as:

(A) a unit of vowel duration — one for ह्रस्व, two for दीर्घ vowels

(B) the name of a noun case

(C) a kind of Sanskrit verb

(D) a poetic name for the Motherland

**29.** Which pair correctly classifies the vowels by length?

(A) अ, आ are both ह्रस्व; इ, ई are both दीर्घ (B) आ, ई, ऊ are ह्रस्व; अ, इ, उ are दीर्घ

(C) all of अ आ इ ई उ ऊ are दीर्घ

(D) अ, इ, उ are ह्रस्व (short); आ, ई, ऊ are दीर्घ (long)

**30.** The lesson points to the chapter on वर्णमात्रा for vowel length. Using that idea, why might careless lengthening of the इ in a word be a problem?

(A) Because इ has no long counterpart, so lengthening is impossible.

(B) Because इ (short) and ई (long) are different vowels, swapping them can change the word's meaning.

(C) Because vowel length affects only आ, never इ.

(D) Because इ and ई are pronounced identically, so it never matters.

**31.** Why does the spelling आनन्दमठः matter for understanding the chapter, beyond mere correctness?

(A) It is the name of the song's author, so the spelling identifies a person.

(B) It is a grammatical case of मातृ, so the spelling shows a declension.

(C) It is a verb meaning 'to salute', so the spelling shows a conjugation.

(D) It names the novel ('Abbey of Bliss') that contains the song; the long आ keeps the sense 'bliss', anchoring both the title and the vowel-length lesson.

**32.** वन्दे is first-person singular ('I salute'). Built on the same root वन्द्, the third-person SINGULAR ('he/she salutes') would be:

(A) वन्दे

(B) वन्दन्ते

(C) वन्दते

(D) वन्दसे

**33.** The verb सिञ्चन्ति in स्वेदबिन्दुभिः सिञ्चन्ति is in which person and number?

(A) third person plural ('they water') (B) first person singular ('I water')

(C) second person plural ('you all water') (D) third person singular ('he waters')

**34.** प्रक्षालयति ('washes') in समुद्रः ... प्रक्षालयति agrees with समुद्रः. Its singular ending fits because:

(A) समुद्रः is plural, so the verb should really be प्रक्षालयन्ति.

(B) प्रक्षालयति is first person, agreeing with 'I'.

(C) समुद्रः is a singular subject, so the verb is third-person singular प्रक्षालयति.

(D) the object चरणौ is dual, so the verb must be dual प्रक्षालयतः.

**35.** Which transformation correctly conjugates वन्दे into 'we salute' (first person plural)?

(A) वन्दे

(B) वन्दामहे

(C) वन्दन्ते

(D) वन्देथे

**36.** Why is वन्दे a complete sentence by itself, while मातरम् alone is not?

(A) मातरम् is the verb and वन्दे is the noun, so it is the reverse.

(B) Both are verbs, so either can stand alone.

(C) वन्दे is a finite verb carrying subject ('I') and action; मातरम् is only a noun-object lacking a verb.

(D) Neither can stand alone; both are bare stems.

**37.** In सिञ्चन्ति (active, parasmaipada-type ending -अन्ति) versus वन्दते (-ते ending), the contrast illustrates that Sanskrit verbs:

(A) always use exactly one set of endings for every root.

(B) have no person or number, only tense.

(C) can take different sets of personal endings (e.g. -अन्ति vs -ते) depending on the root's class/pada.

(D) mark person on the noun, never on the verb itself.

**38.** The poem pictures the Himalaya as a मुकुट (crown) at Bharat's head and the समुद्र (ocean) washing her feet. What spatial logic makes this imagery geographically apt?

(A) The Himalaya lies to the south and the seas to the north, so the image is inverted but still poetic.

(B) Both lie to the east, so head and feet face the sunrise.

(C) The placement is random and carries no geographic sense.

(D) The Himalaya lies to the NORTH (top) and the seas lie to the SOUTH (below), matching crown-at-head and waters-at-feet.

**39.** Calling the Himalaya पर्वतराजः and the ocean रत्नाकरः are both examples of the poem's technique of:

(A) personifying/ennobling nature with honorific titles to glorify the Motherland

(B) listing dry geographical facts without praise

(C) criticising nature as an obstacle

(D) naming historical kings who ruled Bharat

**40.** How does सस्यश्यामला reinforce the poem's portrait of Bharat alongside the Himalaya-crown and ocean-feet images?

(A) It contradicts the other images by calling her barren.

(B) It replaces the nature imagery with city imagery.

(C) It adds her fertile, crop-green body to the picture, completing a head-to-foot, abundant Motherland.

(D) It describes only the ocean, not the land.

**41.** The poem honours कृषकबान्धवाः who water the land with their sweat. Reading this together with सस्यश्यामला, the poet implies that Bharat's green abundance is:

(A) entirely due to the ocean's washing of her feet

(B) the result of the Himalaya's snow alone

(C) unconnected to any human effort

(D) the fruit of the farmers' toil, not merely a gift of nature

**42.** Why is तीर्थक्षेत्राणि (holy places) a fitting item in a hymn that already praises mountains, seas and fields?

(A) It signals that the land lacks rivers and so needs holy sites.

(B) It is unrelated to praise and only lists tourist spots.

(C) It adds a SACRED dimension, so Bharat is praised for spiritual worth as well as natural beauty.

(D) It shows the land is small enough to hold few shrines.

**43.** Putting the images together, the lesson presents Bharat primarily as:

- (A) a powerful warrior-queen leading armies
- (B) a revered, life-giving MOTHER whose body is the very land — crowned, sea-washed, crop-rich and holy
- (C) a distant goddess unconnected to the soil
- (D) a wealthy merchant city of trade

44. A teacher asks: 'How can a single word like रत्नाकरः stand for the ocean without naming समुद्र?' The best explanation is:

- (A) रत्नाकरः is simply another spelling of समुद्र with the same letters.
- (B) It is a descriptive epithet ('mine of jewels') that the reader decodes by its members and context to mean the ocean.
- (C) रत्नाकरः literally contains the word समुद्र inside it.
- (D) Sanskrit forbids the plain word समुद्र, so a substitute is required.

45. Who composed वन्दे मातरम्, and into which work was it set?

- (A) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, in his novel आनन्दमठः (1882)
- (B) Rabindranath Tagore, in a play of the 1900s
- (C) the two children in the lesson, as a school song
- (D) an unnamed ancient poet, in a Vedic hymn

46. An उपन्यासः is a novel. In the lesson, why is it significant that वन्दे मातरम् first appeared inside an उपन्यासः rather than as a standalone poem?

- (A) It proves the song has no author, since novels are anonymous.
- (B) It means the song is actually a cooking recipe in a story.
- (C) It shows the song arose within a larger story (आनन्दमठः), giving it a narrative and patriotic context.
- (D) It shows the song predates all Sanskrit literature.

47. जिज्ञासा is what drives the lesson's plot. The word is best glossed and explained as:

- (A) 'salutation' — it is the act of bowing to the song
- (B) 'sweat' — it is the farmers' labour in the song
- (C) 'crown' — it is the Himalaya's role in the song
- (D) 'desire to know / curiosity' — it is what makes the children ask the mother to explain the song.

48. If the children had felt no जिज्ञासा, what would the lesson's structure most likely lack?

- (A) the explanatory dialogue, since the mother explains the song in RESPONSE to their curiosity
- (B) the Himalaya, since जिज्ञासा is what places the mountain in the north
- (C) the accusative case, since जिज्ञासा governs मातरम्
- (D) the author's name, since जिज्ञासा identifies Bankim Chandra

49. Identify the case of the underlined word: in देवाः भारतमातुः वन्दनम् कुर्वन्ति ('the gods do salutation OF the Motherland'), भारतमातुः is:



- (A) genitive singular — 'of the Motherland'
- (B) accusative singular — the object being saluted
- (C) instrumental singular — the means of saluting
- (D) nominative singular — the one saluting

**50.** In वन्दे मातरम् सस्यश्यामलाम् सुजलाम्, how many words are in the accusative agreeing with the object?

- (A) only one — मातरम्; the others are nominative descriptions
- (B) three — मातरम्, सस्यश्यामलाम् and सुजलाम् all agree as feminine accusative singular
- (C) two — मातरम् and सुजलाम्, while सस्यश्यामलाम् is genitive
- (D) none — वन्दे takes no object so all are nominative

**51.** Match each word to its case-role: (i) समुद्रः, (ii) चरणौ, (iii) भारतमातुः in समुद्रः भारतमातुः चरणौ प्रक्षालयति.

- (A) (i) accusative object, (ii) nominative subject, (iii) instrumental means
- (B) (i) genitive possessor, (ii) instrumental means, (iii) nominative subject
- (C) (i) instrumental means, (ii) genitive possessor, (iii) accusative object
- (D) (i) nominative subject, (ii) accusative object, (iii) genitive possessor

**52.** Which sentence uses the CORRECT case on every word for 'the farmers water the fields with water' (an analogous test phrase)?

- (A) कृषकैः क्षेत्राणि जलानि सिञ्चन्ति
- (B) कृषकाः क्षेत्रैः जलैः सिञ्चन्ति
- (C) कृषकान् क्षेत्राणि जलैः सिञ्चन्ति
- (D) कृषकाः क्षेत्राणि जलैः सिञ्चन्ति

**53.** A student labels मातरम् as 'nominative because it ends in -म् and ends words'. Correct the reasoning.

- (A) The student is right: -म् always marks the nominative.
- (B) मातरम् is genitive; the -म् marks possession.
- (C) मातरम् is vocative; the -म् marks address.
- (D) The -म् here is the ACCUSATIVE-singular ending; nominative singular of मातृ is माता, with no -म्.

**54.** Why can the single phrase स्वेदबिन्दुभिः tell us the verb in its clause must be one of 'action done BY some means'?

- (A) Because the instrumental case marks the MEANS, implying a transitive action performed with those drops (here, watering).
- (B) Because the instrumental marks the subject, telling us the drops act on their own.
- (C) Because the instrumental marks the object, telling us the drops are watered.
- (D) Because the instrumental marks possession, telling us whose drops they are.

**55.** A learner argues: 'Since वन्दे मातरम् has only two words and no separate word for I, there is no subject.' The best correction is:

- (A) Correct — Sanskrit sentences need no subject at all.
- (B) The subject is मातरम्, which means 'I'.

(C) वन्दे is a noun, so the sentence really has two subjects.

(D) The subject 'I' is built INTO the verb वन्दे (first-person singular), so the subject is present though unwritten as a separate word.

**56.** Synthesising grammar and content: which statement is FULLY correct about वन्दे मातरम्?

(A) वन्दे is 1st-person-singular 'I salute' (root वन्द्); मातरम् is the accusative-singular object (stem मातृ); the line opens Bankim Chandra's song from आनन्दमठः (1882).

(B) वन्दे is 3rd-person-plural 'they salute'; मातरम् is nominative; from a Tagore play.

(C) वन्दे means 'I love'; मातरम् is genitive 'of mother'; from the 12th century.

(D) वन्दे is a noun 'salutation'; मातरम् is the verb; author unknown.

**57.** A student writes the 'improved' line वन्दे माता पर्वतराजेन, claiming it means 'I salute Mother by the king of mountains.' Identify ALL the grammatical faults.

(A) No faults; the sentence is correct as written.

(B) Only one fault: माता is fine, but पर्वतराजेन should be पर्वतराजम्.

(C) Two faults: माता should be accusative मातरम् (object of वन्दे), and पर्वतराजेन (instrumental) does not fit — there is no 'by means of' role here.

(D) Only one fault: पर्वतराजेन is fine, but वन्दे should be नमः.

**58.** The lesson teaches that compounds like देशभक्तः are decoded by splitting members, and that vowel length is meaning-bearing. Applying BOTH ideas, which analysis is sound?

(A) देशभक्तः = देश + भक्तः; but आ and अ are interchangeable, so length never matters.

(B) देशभक्तः = देश + भक्तः ('country-devoted'); and a careless आ→अ shift (आनन्द→अनन्द) could destroy a word's sense.

(C) देशभक्तः cannot be split; and आ→अ never changes meaning.

(D) देशभक्तः = 'devotion's country'; and आ→अ only changes the gender.

**59.** The stem मातृ forms nominative माता, accusative मातरम्, genitive मातुः. Which row correctly pairs a CASE with its मातृ-form and meaning?

(A) nominative singular → मातरम् → 'the mother (as subject)'

(B) accusative singular → मातरम् → 'the mother (as object saluted)'

(C) genitive singular → माता → 'of the mother'

(D) accusative singular → मातुः → 'the mother (as object)'

**60.** Comprehension synthesis: a single statement must be true on meaning, imagery AND grammar. Which is it?

(A) The hymn reveres a warrior-king (वन्दे + nominative माता), with the ocean as a crown and the Himalaya at the feet.

(B) The hymn loves a foreign queen (वन्दे = 'I love'), with deserts replacing the crops.

(C) The hymn lists trade routes (वन्दे + genitive मातुः), naming the author as Tagore.

(D) The hymn reveres Bharat as a mother (वन्दे + accusative मातरम्), crowned by the Himalaya (पर्वतराजः) and washed at the feet by the ocean (स्तावरः, genitive भारतमातुः चरणौ).

# Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 1: वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram) — Paper 3

## Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans |
|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|
| 1  | C   | 11 | C   | 21 | D   | 31 | D   | 41 | D   | 51 | D   |
| 2  | A   | 12 | B   | 22 | A   | 32 | C   | 42 | C   | 52 | D   |
| 3  | D   | 13 | A   | 23 | A   | 33 | A   | 43 | B   | 53 | D   |
| 4  | C   | 14 | C   | 24 | B   | 34 | C   | 44 | B   | 54 | A   |
| 5  | C   | 15 | B   | 25 | D   | 35 | B   | 45 | A   | 55 | D   |
| 6  | D   | 16 | C   | 26 | A   | 36 | C   | 46 | C   | 56 | A   |
| 7  | B   | 17 | A   | 27 | D   | 37 | C   | 47 | D   | 57 | C   |
| 8  | B   | 18 | B   | 28 | A   | 38 | D   | 48 | A   | 58 | B   |
| 9  | B   | 19 | A   | 29 | D   | 39 | A   | 49 | A   | 59 | B   |
| 10 | C   | 20 | B   | 30 | B   | 40 | C   | 50 | B   | 60 | D   |

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

## Worked Solutions

**1. (C)** वन्दे is the active first-person singular of root वन्द् ('to salute/revere'), and मातरम् is its accusative object. Rendering it 'I offer salutation to the Mother' preserves both the active sense and the reverence. The idea that वन्दे is passive or that the Mother is the agent is wrong; वन्दे does not mean romantic love (that is कामये); and मातरम् is accusative (the object), not nominative.

**2. (A)** वन्दे expresses reverential salutation, distinct from affection (कामये / स्निह्यामि). The reversed pairing that calls वन्दे 'love' is the classic error the lesson warns against; वन्दे is neither 'see' (दृश) nor 'give' (दा).

**3. (D)** An adjective agrees with the noun it qualifies in case, number and gender. सुजलाम् and सुफलाम् describe मातरम् (accusative singular feminine, object of वन्दे), so they too are accusative singular feminine. They are not subjects (nominative), nor means (instrumental), nor possessors (genitive).

**4. (C)** वन्दे, being a finite transitive verb, takes its object in the accusative (वन्दे मातरम्). The indeclinable नमस् ('homage') is commonly construed with the dative of the one honoured (नमो मात्रे, 'homage to the mother'). The chapter pairs वन्दे + accusative; the claim that they are reversed, identical, or caseless is false.

**5. (C)** Feminine ऋ-stems of relationship (मातृ, स्वसृ, दुहितृ) take guṇa of the ऋ to अर् before the accusative-singular ending -अम्: मातृ → मातरम्, so स्वसृ → स्वसारम्. The forms स्वसृम् (no guṇa), स्वस्राम् (a wrong ā-stem ending) and स्वसाः (nominative-like) are all incorrect.

**6. (D)** The accusative singular of the r-stem मातृ is मातरम्. The form मात्राम् would be an accusative of मात्रा ('a measure'), a different word — so the writer has both used the wrong word and the wrong declension. वन्दे correctly governs the accusative (so nominative is wrong), and वन्दे is itself a valid first-person form (no need for वन्दामि here).

**7. (B)** हिमालयः is an अकारान्त masculine noun; as the accusative-singular object of वन्दे it ends in -म् (हिमालयम्). It is masculine, not feminine; -म् here is accusative, not genitive (which would be हिमालयस्य); and वन्दे governs the accusative, not the nominative (हिमालयः).

**8. (B)** मातृ → मातरौ shows the dual ending -औ, and as the object of वन्दे it is the accusative dual ('the two mothers'). The singular accusative is मातरम्; the nominative plural is मातरः; the genitive singular is मातुः. So -औ here is accusative dual.

**9. (B)** श्यामला is a feminine आ-stem adjective; its accusative singular is श्यामलाम् (-आम्), agreeing in gender, number and case with the feminine मातरम्. Masculine/neuter accusative singulars end in -अम्, not -आम्; -आम् here is singular, not plural; and the long आ is correct, not a sandhi error.

**10. (C)** The object of वन्दे must be accusative, and the feminine adjective must agree: सुफलाम् मातरम् (both feminine accusative singular). सुफला माता is nominative (wrong as object); सुफलायाः मातुः is genitive; and सुफलम् would be a masculine/neuter ending that fails to agree with the feminine मातरम्.

**11. (C)** रत्नाकरः = रत्न ('jewel') + आकर ('mine/store'), 'store of jewels'. Replacing the first member with जल ('water') gives जलाकरः, 'a store/reservoir of water'. It does not mean 'king' (that is राज), nor 'water-less' (which would need a negating prefix), nor 'jewel-carrier'.

**12. (B)** पर्वतराजः is a षष्ठी-तत्पुरुषः पर्वतानाम् राजा. देवराजः = देवानाम् राजा has the identical genitive-tatpurusha structure. महाराजः is a कर्मधारय (adjective + noun, 'great king'), not a genitive relation; 'king is a son' mis-reads राजपुत्रः; and 'a king and a mountain' is a द्वन्द्व (coordinative), a different compound type.

**13. (A)** श्यामला ('dark/green') is qualified by सस्य as the cause/means: 'dark-green by reason of (its) crops' — a तृतीया (instrumental) tatpurusha. It is not a द्वन्द्व ('crops and darkness'), and although the whole word describes the Mother, the internal relation is instrumental, not a self-contained bahuvrīhi reading; nor is it a reduplication.

**14. (C)** In these compounds the SECOND member भक्तः ('devoted to') is the head, and the FIRST member names the object of devotion. विद्या ('knowledge') as the first member yields विद्याभक्तः, 'devoted to learning'. देश would give देशभक्तः, धर्म would give धर्मभक्तः, and समुद्र is unrelated to विद्या.

**15. (B)** बान्धव is an अकारान्त masculine; -आः is its nominative-plural ending, so कृषकबान्धवाः means '(the) farmer-brethren' as plural subjects. The accusative singular would be -अम् (बान्धवम्), the instrumental plural -ऐः (बान्धवैः), and the genitive singular -अस्य (बान्धवस्य).

**16. (C)** रत्नाकरः splits cleanly into रत्न ('jewel') + आकर ('mine'), a poetic name for the ocean. The other splits are spurious: पर्वतराजः is पर्वत + राजः ('king of mountains'), not पर्व + तराजः; सस्यश्यामला is सस्य + श्यामला ('crop-dark'), the negating split is invented; and देशभक्तः is देश + भक्तः, not देशभ + क्तः.

**17. (A)** The genitive singular of the r-stem मातृ is मातुः (as in भारतमातुः, 'of the Motherland'). मातरम् is the accusative, मातरि the locative, and मात्रा the instrumental — none of which expresses 'of the mother'.

**18. (B)** The genitive marks possession independent of the possessed noun's case or number; 'the Motherland's hands' keeps भारतमातुः genitive just as 'the Motherland's feet' did. The dual हस्तौ does not change the possessor's case; possession is shown by the genitive, not the locative; and swapping the body-part does not turn the possessor accusative.

**19. (A)** कस्याः is feminine genitive singular ('of whom/whose', feminine). A grammatical answer must agree, so भारतमातुः is feminine genitive singular. It is not nominative (the subject is समुद्रः), not accusative (the object is चरणौ), and not instrumental (no 'means' is asked).

**20. (B)** चरण is an अकारान्त masculine; -औ marks the dual, and as the object of प्रक्षालयति it is accusative dual ('the two feet'). The accusative and nominative dual look alike for such stems, but the role here is object; the genitive dual would be चरणयोः and the instrumental dual चरणाभ्याम्.

**21. (D)** 'The Himalaya's' (possessor) needs the genitive: हिमालयस्य. With चरणौ as the object washed, the correct phrase is समुद्रः हिमालयस्य चरणौ प्रक्षालयति. हिमालयम् is accusative (wrong for the possessor), हिमालयः is nominative (would make it the subject), and हिमालयेन is instrumental ('by the Himalaya').

**22. (A)** Neuter अ-stems take -ऐः in the instrumental plural, so जल → जलैः ('with waters'). जलानि is the nominative/accusative plural, जलेभ्यः the dative/ablative plural, and जलानाम् the genitive plural — none expresses 'by means of'. (The -भिः of स्वेदबिन्दुभिः is the u-stem instrumental-plural; both -भिः and -ऐः render the same instrumental 'with'.)

**23. (A)** The ending -भिः marks the instrumental plural, the means: 'with sweat-drops'. 'Of the drops' (possession) would be the genitive plural स्वेदबिन्दूनाम्. -भिः is neither vocative ('O drops!') nor accusative (object) — those are different endings and meanings.

**24. (B)** Just as स्वेदबिन्दुभिः ('with sweat-drops') is instrumental of means, अश्रुभिः ('with tears') would also be instrumental, expressing the means of watering. It is not the subject (the farmers act), not a recipient (dative), and not a place (locative).

**25. (D)** The verb's doers, the farmers, stand in the nominative (कृषकाः); the means by which they water, the sweat-drops, stand in the instrumental (स्वेदबिन्दुभिः). Reversing the roles, calling both instrumental, or making the farmers an object misreads the sentence's structure.

**26. (A)** Sweat is shed in many drops, so the plural स्वेदबिन्दुभिः ('with sweat-drops') fits the sense. The instrumental does have a singular (-ना type), so it is not plural-only; the means need not match the number of the agent automatically — it reflects the actual multiplicity of drops.

**27. (D)** आ (दीर्घ, two mātrās) and अ (ह्रस्व, one mātrā) are separate vowel sounds; substituting one for the other can change or destroy a word's meaning (आनन्द 'bliss' vs the non-word/altered अनन्द). They are not the same sound, not consonant-vs-vowel, and not a nasal/oral pair.

**28. (A)** मात्रा here means the unit of pronunciation-time of a vowel: a short (ह्रस्व) vowel is one mātrā, a long (दीर्घ) vowel two. It is not a noun case, not a verb class, and not a name of Bharat (note मात्रा 'measure' ≠ मातृ 'mother').

**29. (D)** The basic vowels pair up by length: अ/आ, इ/ई, उ/ऊ, with the first of each pair short (ह्रस्व, one mātrā) and the second long (दीर्घ, two mātrās). So अ इ उ are short and आ ई ऊ are long. The other groupings mis-assign or flatten this distinction.

**30. (B)** Just as आ/अ differ, इ (ह्रस्व) and ई (दीर्घ) are distinct vowels; substituting one for the other can alter meaning. इ does have a long counterpart ई; the length principle is not limited to आ; and इ and ई are NOT identical in duration.

**31. (D)** आनन्दमठः is the novel ('monastery/abbey of bliss') in which वन्दे मातरम् appears; आनन्द ('bliss') needs the long आ, which is why it doubles as a vowel-length illustration. It is not the author's name (that is बङ्किमचन्द्रः), not a case of मातृ, and not a verb.

**32. (C)** वन्द् is an ātmanepada root: first-person singular वन्दे ('I salute'), third-person singular वन्दते ('he/she salutes'). वन्दे is the 'I' form, वन्दन्ते is third-person plural ('they salute'), and वन्दसे is second-person singular ('you salute').

**33. (A)** सिञ्चन्ति ends in -अन्ति, the third-person plural active ending: 'they water' (the farmers). First-person singular would be सिञ्चामि, second-person plural सिञ्चथ, and third-

person singular सिञ्चति.

**34. (C)** A finite verb agrees with its SUBJECT. समुद्रः ('the ocean') is third-person singular, so प्रक्षालयति (3rd sg.) is correct. The subject is singular, not plural (so not -अन्ति); प्रक्षालयति is third person, not first; and the verb agrees with the subject's number, not the object's dual.

**35. (B)** वन्द् is ātmanepada; first-person plural is वन्दामहे ('we salute'). वन्दे is first-person singular ('I'), वन्दन्ते is third-person plural ('they'), and वन्देथे is second-person dual. So 'we salute' = वन्दामहे.

**36. (C)** A finite verb like वन्दे encodes person, number and action ('I salute') and can stand as a minimal sentence. मातरम् is an accusative noun (an object) with no verb, so it cannot. The roles are not reversed (मातरम् is not a verb), they are not both verbs, and वन्दे is a fully inflected form, not a bare stem.

**37. (C)** सिञ्चन्ति uses the -अन्ति (parasmaipada) third-plural ending, while वन्दते uses the -ते (ātmanepada) third-singular ending; Sanskrit roots take different ending-sets (pada) by class. Verbs do not all share one ending-set, they DO mark person and number, and that marking is on the verb, not the noun.

**38. (D)** Bharat's Himalaya is in the north (imagined as the high 'head/crown') and the oceans wash the southern coasts (the 'feet') — the imagery mirrors real geography. The reversed (Himalaya-south) claim is false, both are not east, and the placement is deliberately geographic, not random.

**39. (A)** Both names elevate natural features with grand titles ('king of mountains', 'mine of jewels'), praising Bharat's landscape. They are not neutral facts, not criticism, and not the names of human kings — they are poetic honorifics for nature.

**40. (C)** सस्यश्यामला ('dark-green with crops') paints Bharat's fertile midland, complementing the crown (head) and ocean (feet) to give a complete, abundant figure. It does not call her barren, does not introduce cities, and describes the cultivated LAND, not the ocean.

**41. (D)** Linking सस्यश्यामला (crop-green) with कृषकबान्धवाः watering the soil by sweat shows the greenery as earned by farmers' labour. The ocean and the Himalaya beautify her but are not credited with the crops, and the imagery explicitly ties abundance TO human effort.

**42. (C)** Naming तीर्थक्षेत्राणि ('places of pilgrimage') adds holiness to the catalogue of mountains, seas and fields, praising Bharat's sacredness alongside her beauty. It does not imply a lack of rivers, is not a neutral tourist list, and does not suggest smallness.

**43. (B)** The hymn's controlling image is Bharat-as-mother whose body is the land: Himalaya-crown, ocean-feet, crop-green skin, holy sites. She is not depicted as a warrior-

queen, nor as detached from the soil (she IS the soil), nor as a merchant city.

**44. (B)** रत्नाकरः ('store of jewels') is an epithet: by analysing रत्न + आकर and using context (the thing washing Bharat's feet) the reader identifies the ocean. It is not a respelling of समुद्र, does not contain समुद्र, and समुद्र is a perfectly usable word — the epithet is a poetic choice.

**45. (A)** The chapter credits बङ्किमचन्द्रः चट्टोपाध्यायः with the song, embedded in his 1882 novel आनन्दमठः. It is not Tagore's, not composed by the lesson's children, and not an anonymous Vedic hymn.

**46. (C)** Being part of the novel आनन्दमठः situates the song within a patriotic narrative rather than as an isolated verse. It does not make the work anonymous, is certainly not a recipe, and does not predate Sanskrit literature — the novel is a 19th-century work.

**47. (D)** जिज्ञासा means the desire to know (curiosity); the children's जिज्ञासा prompts the mother's explanation, framing the lesson. It is not salutation (वन्दनम्), not sweat (स्वेदः), and not crown (मुकुटः).

**48. (A)** The mother's explanation is triggered by the children's जिज्ञासा (curiosity); without it the explanatory dialogue would not happen. जिज्ञासा does not position the Himalaya, does not govern any case, and does not name the author — those are separate content elements.

**49. (A)** Here भारतमातुः ('of the Motherland') depends on वन्दनम् as a possessive/objective genitive, the same -उः genitive form. It is not accusative (which would be भारतमातरम्), not instrumental (भारतमात्रा), and not nominative (भारतमाता).

**50. (B)** मातरम् is the accusative object; सस्यश्यामलाम् and सुजलाम् are adjectives agreeing with it, all feminine accusative singular (note the -आम्/-अम् accusative endings). The other counts wrongly treat the adjectives as nominative or genitive, or deny that वन्दे takes an object.

**51. (D)** समुद्रः ('the ocean') is the nominative subject that does the washing; चरणौ ('the two feet') is the accusative object washed; भारतमातुः ('of the Motherland') is the genitive possessor of those feet. The other mappings scramble subject, object and possessor.

**52. (D)** The doers are nominative (कृषकाः), the fields are the accusative object (क्षेत्राणि, neuter pl.), and the means is instrumental (जलैः, 'with water'): कृषकाः क्षेत्राणि जलैः सिञ्चन्ति. Making the farmers instrumental (कृषकैः) or accusative (कृषकान्), the fields instrumental (क्षेत्रैः), or the water accusative (जलानि) breaks the role-to-case mapping.

**53. (D)** For मातुः, the nominative singular is माता and the accusative singular is मातरम् — so the -म् is the accusative marker, not nominative. -म् does not always mark nominative; it is not the genitive (मातुः) nor the vocative (मातः) here.



**54. (A)** The instrumental स्वेदबिन्दुभिः signals 'by means of (sweat-drops)', which presupposes an action carried out using them — the farmers' watering (सिञ्चन्ति). The instrumental is not the subject (the drops do not act alone), not the object (they are not watered), and not possession (that is genitive).

**55. (D)** Sanskrit verbs encode person and number, so वन्दे already contains its subject 'I'; no separate pronoun is required. The sentence is not subject-less; मातरम् is the object, not 'I'; and वन्दे is a verb, not a second subject.

**56. (A)** Every clause must hold: वन्दे is first-person singular of वन्द् ('I salute'); मातरम् is the accusative singular of मातृ (the object); the line is from Bankim Chandra's 1882 novel आनन्दमठः. The distractors err on person/number, case, meaning, authorship, or date.

**57. (C)** वन्दे needs an accusative object, so माता (nominative) must be मातरम्. And पर्वतराजेन is instrumental ('by the king of mountains'), which has no sensible role in 'I salute Mother' — there is no instrument of saluting intended. So there are two faults, not zero or one; and वन्दे itself is a correct verb (no need for नमः).

**58. (B)** Both principles hold together: split देश + भक्तः for 'devoted to country', and treat आ (दीर्घ) vs अ (ह्रस्व) as meaning-bearing so आनन्द ('bliss') must keep its long आ. Claims that length is irrelevant, that compounds cannot be split, or that आ→अ merely changes gender are all false.

**59. (B)** For the r-stem मातृ: nominative singular = माता (subject), accusative singular = मातरम् (object), genitive singular = मातुः ('of'). The correct pairing is accusative → मातरम् → object. The distractors mis-assign मातरम् to the nominative, माता to the genitive, or मातुः to the accusative.

**60. (D)** All three layers must be right: meaning (reverence for the mother), grammar (वन्दे + accusative मातरम्; genitive भारतमातुः with चरणौ), and imagery (Himalaya = crown/पर्वतराजः at the head, ocean = रत्नाकरः washing the feet). The distractors invert the imagery, mis-gloss वन्दे, mis-case मातृ, or wrongly credit Tagore.